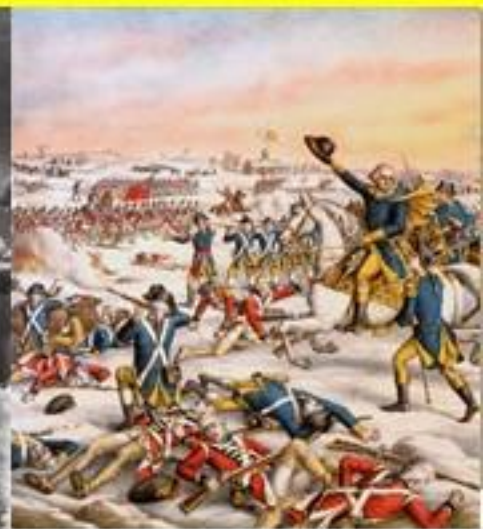


WORLD HISTORY



MODULE – 32

RISE OF FASCISM AND NAZISM - 1

WHAT ARE THE CAUSES FOR THE GROWTH OF FASCISM IN ITALY?

1 HUMILIATION OF ITALY

1 Italy attended the Paris Peace Conference with great expectations.

2 The secret Treaty of London which was signed in 1915 with the Allies gave Italy great hope.

3 At Paris, Orlando presented the demands of Italy.

4 But the US President Woodrow Wilson rejected the Treaty of London.

5 Italian claims over territories on the Adriatic Sea, some Turkish provinces and Albania in the Balkan were all turned down.

Woodrow Wilson



WHAT ARE THE CAUSES FOR THE GROWTH OF FASCISM IN ITALY?

1 HUMILIATION OF ITALY

- 6 Thus Italy gained nothing in the Paris Peace Conference. "Italy had won the war but had lost peace". Italy was disappointed. The representatives of Italy were forced to boycott the conference.
- 7 They felt that the Allies had purposely deceived Italy.
- 8 This discontentment created a feeling of revolt among the middle class youth.
- 9 They decided to form an organization and unite in order to avenge their national humiliation and treachery.



WHAT ARE THE CAUSES FOR THE GROWTH OF FASCISM IN ITALY?

2 ECONOMIC CONDITION

- 1 During the war, Italy was forced to spend huge amount more than her national income.
- 2 Unemployment prevailed.
- 3 People believed that government was responsible for such a situation. They wanted an alternative government.
- 4 The rise of the Fascist Party was also a result of above dissatisfaction.



WHAT ARE THE CAUSES FOR THE GROWTH OF FASCISM IN ITALY?

3 SPREAD OF SOCIALISM

- 1 The unemployment problem, poverty and inflation helped the spread of Socialism.
- 2 The believers in Marxism had a political party called Social Democrats of Italy.
- 3 In the 1919 election they gained 156 seats out of 574.
- 4 This party helped a lot for the rise and development of Fascism in Italy.



- 1** Benito Mussolini was the originator of the idea of Fascism. He was born in 1883.
- 2** Mussolini's father an ironsmith, was a follower of Socialism. Hence, Mussolini was influenced by the socialistic ideology.
- 3** He was a school teacher a trade unionist and a journalist. He was imprisoned in 1908 for revolutionary ideas.
- 4** In 1912 he started the editing of Avanthi! a socialist journal.



- 5 He was a bitter opponent of the Church. When the First World War broke out, the Italian Government decided not to take part in the War.
- 6 But Mussolini propagated that the Italian Government should immediately join the war in favour of the Allies. For that Mussolini was punished.
- 7 But later Italy was forced to join the war on the side of the Allies. As a result, Mussolini became popular.
- 8 He also participated in the war as a soldier.
- 9 The Bolshevik Revolution took place in Russia in 1917. The people of Italy also were influenced by the revolution.
- 10 The communists of Italy also were planning for a massive revolution.



11 Mussolini, who was a staunch opponent of Bolshevism, decided to start a new party to fight Communism. In March 1919 the Fascist Party was established under his leadership.

12 The members wore black shirts and were equipped with arms. The party had its own flag.

13 The members were well disciplined and Mussolini was their chief commander.

14 In the first party convention of Milan, Mussolini announced the programmes and Charter of demands of the party. They were:

- Nationalisation of factories
- Confiscation of surplus money from the capitalists
- Universal Franchise
- Forfeiture of the Church property
- Eight hours work in factories
- Framing of a new constitution.



- 15** These demands of the Fascist Party soon achieved popularity in Italy.
- 16** The number of members increased very rapidly. In 1919 there were only seventeen thousand members in the party. The number increased to 3 lakhs in 1922.
- 17** The Fascists captured the offices of the Socialist and the Communist parties by force.
- 18** In October 1922, the Fascist Party had its party convention at Naples.



19 A Charter of Demands was passed at the convention.

20 They include induction of Fascist members in the Cabinet, new election to the Legislatures and the adoption of a vigorous foreign policy.

21 But the government refused to concede.

22 The Fascists therefore marched on to Rome, under the leadership of Mussolini.

23 They captured all the government officers.

24 The government asked the king Victor Immanuel III to promulgate martial law. Mussolini was invited to form the ministry.



King Victor Immanuel III



1 Mussolini was an action oriented Prime Minister. He took the following steps for the reorganization of administration.

- The dacoits living in the interiors of Naples and Sicily were crushed.
- The economic and social conditions of the labourers were improved.
- Trade Unions were abolished.
- The entire powers of the Parliament were snatched.
- Members faithful to the leader alone were appointed as ministers and officers.



2

- Elections were conducted under the basis of the changed law.
- The Fascist Party got a complete majority in the National Parliament.
- After elections, Mussolini adopted some measures to crush opponents.

- All local bodies were suspended.
- Only Fascist lawyers were allowed to practice.
- In 1926, all political parties were banned.
- The cabinet system of government came to an end.

- Freedom of the Press was curtailed.
- Unlimited powers were given to the police department.
- Members of the opposition parties were imprisoned.



- 1** Rule of one leader and one party was the ideology of Fascism.
- 2** He had no faith in democracy and hated the majority.
- 3** He believed in the supremacy of the state.
- 4** The individual had no right. The individual was merely a means to recognise the existence of the state.



- 1** After the First World War, harsh peace was imposed on Germany and other defeated countries.
- 2** This had created intense nationalist upsurge in Germany.
- 3** The economic breakdown and the rise of socialist parties paved the way for the rise of Hitler and Nazism in Germany.
- 4** Similarly, such situation arose in Italy and Japan.
- 5** This resulted in the Axis formation.

- 6** The aggressive foreign policy of Hitler led to the Second World War.



WHAT WAS THE CONDITION OF GERMANY AT THE END OF WORLD WAR I?

1 At the end of the World War I, the German King William was forced to abdicate.

2 A republic was proclaimed in Germany.

3 Friedrich Ebert, the leader of the Social - Democratic Party formed a temporary government.

4 This was followed by an election to the Constituent Assembly.

5 The Social Democratic Party emerged as the largest party.

6 The session of the Constituent Assembly was held in the city of Weimar.

7 A new constitution was drafted. This is known as Weimar Constitution.



Friedrich Ebert

WHAT LED TO THE REVOLT IN GERMANY?

- 1** The Treaty of Versailles was very harsh and humiliating to Germany. It suffered territorial loss.
- 2** The policy of disarmament was imposed. The war reparation was enormous.
- 3** Germany was held responsible for the World War. This affected the sentiments of the Germans.
- 4** A group of people opposed the signing of the Treaty of Versailles.



WHAT LED TO THE REVOLT IN GERMANY?

5 Dr. Kapp:

- In March 1920, the royalists under the leadership of Dr. Kapp revolted.
- But he failed and surrendered before the republican government.



Dr.Kapp

6 Ludendorff:

- The second such revolt was led by Ludendorff. He was assisted by Hitler.
- Ludendorff and Hitler were arrested and imprisoned for 5 years.
- It was during this jail life Hitler wrote the famous book Mein Kampf which later became the Bible of the Nazi party.



Ludendorff

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